Date: March 19, 2026 Attendance:

Completed By: Larry Hess Officers: 6

Approved By: Commander D. J. Watkins Members: 11

Total: 17

MINUTES OF NITTANY AMERICAN LEGION POST 245, INC

DEPARTMENT OF PA

Nittany Post #245 of the American Legion of Pennsylvania held its regular stated meeting on

March 19, 2026 at 7:00 PM at the Post Home – 1950 Pine Hall Rd. – State College, PA. Commander D. J. Watkins presiding.

SPECIAL GUESTS:

Micheal Keller is the nominee for the Elmer Haffer Camp and requested $250.00 to attend. Don Hartzell made a motion to support Micheal with the $250.00, second by Rich Seifert, motion carried.

PROSPECTIVE NEW MEMBERS:

No Report

SAL:

No Report

AUXILARY:

No Report

RIDERS:

No Report

BSA:

No Report

DISMISSAL OF GUESTS:

Roll call of officers was held, and the following officers were absent: Donald Shalum

Excused: Phil Mowry

MINUTES:

The minutes from the Post February 15, 2026 were emailed, motion to accept by Don Hartzell, second by Tom Palchak. Motion Carried.

The minutes from the PEC March 15, 2026 were handed out. Does anyone have any questions? No questions were asked.

FINANCE REPORT:

Treasurers report was submitted by Finance Officer Chris Solo and recorded as follows:

With the balance of $26,253.09, minus checks written of $6,581.81 and deposits of $12,676.80,

The balance as of March 19, 2026, is $32,348.08.

Motion made by Chris Solo to accept, second by Rich Seifert, motion carried. Subject to Audit.

Post Savings Account Balance is $.10,112.17

MEMBERSHIP: (Larry Hess)

Larry Hess reported that our membership stands at 641 as of March 17, 2026. This is 94.4% of our goal of 679. Balance to go is 38.

NOMINATIONS: (Rich Seifert)

Rich Seifert reported that there isn't any change in the nominations.

EVENTS COMMITTEE: (Tom Palchak)

Tom Palchak reported that the Special Events committee is working with the LITW for the events on the calendar. Events coming up are, trivia, mixed darts, Easter egg hunt, Saint Pat's Day dance. Tom also stated that the Special Events committee has run its course and move to dissolve the committee because they are not planning events anymore. No action was taken at this time.

FUND RAISING: (Mitch DeLong)

Mitch DeLong reported that the PA Lottery presented to the LITW on 3-11-26 on adding games of Keno, Horse Racing, Lottery tickets machine and monitors to the club. They would provide the monitors and install their own internet at no cost to the club. The LITW would profit 5% from the sales of items. This would be a six-month trial. At the end of 6 months, we can deep it or not. The HA board has already approved this. A motion was made by Mitch DeLong to approve the go ahead, second by Tom Palchak, motion carried.

COMMUNITY SERVICE: (DJ Watkins)

D. J. Watkins reported that the awards for the essay contest and dinner went well, we will be hosting a free brunch for our Vietnam Veterans and guest on March 29th from 11:00 to 1:00 pm. This is Vietnam Recognition Day for our Vietnam Veterans.

CELEBRATING AMERICA: (Vacant)

No Report

BUILDING & GROUNDS: (Mitch DeLong)

Mitch DeLong reported that our Spring cleanup day is April 18, 2026 from 8:00 am to 4:00 pm.

Please see the separate attachment on Building & Grounds.

HONOR GUARD: (Rich Jackson)

Rich Jackson reported the Honor Guard preformed one funeral last month. The Honor Guard will stand for the Vietnam Brunch program. Rich is also establishing a tax-free account with Flag and Emblem.

SERVICE OFFICER: (Don Shalom)

No Report

HOME ASSOCIATION: (Mitch DeLong)

Mitch DeLong reported a budget for the Spring clean up day of $3742. Mitch DeLong made a motion to approve this, second by Don Hartzell, motion carried.

Please see separate attachment for B&G notes.

CHAPLIN: (Vacant)

No Report

SEERVICE OFFICER: (Don Shalom)

No Report

NEW MEMBERS:	SERVED:	BRANCH:	DATE APP:	SPONSOR:
Olivia Thornton	Global War	USA	2-17	Larry Hess

A motion by Larry Hess to accept, seconded by Don Hartzell, Motion Carried by a 17-0 margin.

TRANSFERS:	SERVED:	BRANCH:	DATE APP:	SPONSEOR:
Robert J Levitt	Vietnam	USAF	2-23	Larry Hess
Jacob D Reddington	Global War	USA	2-23	Larry Hess
Dennis E Johnsonbaugh	Vietnam	USA	2-23	Larry Hess
Louis A Berrena	Vietnam	USA	3-2	DJ Watkins
Brian L Doyon	Lebanon/Granada	USN	3-3	Mitch DeLong
James M Stuhltrager	Gulf War	USN	3-13	Larry Hess

A motion by Larry Hess to accept, seconded by Don Hartzell, Motion Carried by a 17-0 margin.

SICK CALL:

No Report

OLD BUSINESS:

Chris Solo reported that the new bank accounts have been set up for the Adjutant, Special Events, Building & Grounds and CSC. Debit cards were issued to all but CSC. $100 was deposited in each account to start. Each committee will report at the Post mgt each month.

Chuck Brickell asked about the audit that we were mandated to complete. Larry Hess reported that the forensic audit is too expensive and that the State has not pushed this envelope. The PEC will address this issue and set up audits for the four groups within the Post to be done yearly.

DJ Watkins reported that the web site is set up along with a new Post email address which is; info@nittanypost245.org The old email will have an automatic reply set up to direct people to the new email in June. DJ also mentioned that if you would like wood out back, please sign permit in the back office.

Rich Jackson reported on the Bi-County meeting and shared with us that Post 245 is the only Legion that hosted the Essay Awards and banquet.

Chuck Brickell asked about the shed extension. DJ Watkins reported that there is about $12,000.00 in the boy scouts fund for it and that the High School class will draw up a new plan which will be divided in half for the use by the Post and Boy Scouts. They will also assemble it on site after they tear down the old one.

NEW BUSINESS:

Tom Palchak reported that he will host a booth at the Boy Scouts camporee and will be receiving material from our local politician to hand out.

Chuck Brickell is donating $2000 towards the Over 80, Military and Hardship members dues for 2027. Currently there are 117 at $34 each which is $3978.00. That leaves $1978 needed. Larry said that there is $690 in Post fund so the balance is now $1288.00. Larry Hess made a motion that the Post fund the $1288.00 needed for the dues. Second by Don Hartzell, motion carried. Larry also said that he will review the Military list to make sure they are still on active duty and reduce the number to support.

WRITTEN CORRESPONDENCE: (Commander)

All correspondence will be in the back office if you would like to review it. All notices for Legion events will be in the back office also.

COMMANDERS CMMENTS:

DJ Watkins again asked each one of us to keep our Post and Club clean.

Please remember that each Friday night, we will have a moment of silence for our Veterans serving and those who gave all at 1800 hours and also ring the bell of freedom.

DJ Watkins stated that communication does matter. Please do not spread rumors and address any questions direct to DJ instead of creating more rumors, good or bad.

POST COMRADE MEMORIALS:

Bradley A Fisher, John Brickell

Meeting adjourned at 8:30 PM.

Respectfully Submitted by:

Larry Hess Adjutant

Membership:

Class A: 641

Social: 141

Building and Grounds Report

B&G Report

1. Our current landscaping and snow removal contractor has not shown up for the last 3 snow/ice events. Post volunteers had to shovel and salt several times in order to maintain safe passage by members attending the club. A new snow removal contractor has been contacted. Awaiting a formal proposal to present to the Post for review.

3. The B&G Committee developed a "Spring Cleaning" list for the April 18th cleaning schedule. Lining up several people from ROTC and community service to help.

4. The B&G Committee reviewed the current condition of the game room. Ceiling tiles are in poor condition, lights are fluorescent and in poor condition, walls are smoke stained and discolored, and receptacles/switches/covers are in poor condition. Submitted a funding request for materials to rehab the room.

5. The B&G Committee reviewed the current condition of the dining room ceiling, smoke eaters, and lighting. Ceiling tiles need to be fixed in some places. Opening where there are smoke eater supply and return vents need to be removed and replaced with tiles. Lighting throughout needs to be fixed and/or replaced with LED. Need to bring in scaffolding for work to be completed (safety first). After ceiling is in top condition the committee will review painting the room and thoroughly cleaning the floor.

Legion in the Woods (Social Club) Financial Report

LITW Report

1. February 2026 Finance Report

   Account Balances
   - 9527 HA Operating – $13,360.14
   - 9519 SGOC - $ 18,043.49
   - 9501 Special Events - $0
   - Total balance - $31,403.63

   Transfer of SGOC 60% to Public Interest (Legion) YTD $12,069.40
   - January - $3,952.60
   - February - $8,116.80

   Skills machines debt - $57,802.13, at current rate estimated payoff 8/12/27

2. PA Lottery presentation to the LITW Board on 3/11/26 on adding Keno, Horse Races, Lottery Ticket machine and monitors to the club. Seeking PEC approval to add 4 monitors, one ticket machine and one payout machine.

3. Set a timeline for new by-laws adoption. The by-law revision is required so that the LITW aligns its governing documents with the IRS, PA Dept of Rev, and PA Liquor Enforcement laws, regulations, and codes.

   Timeline:
   - 3/3 - Draft by-laws emailed to the LITW Board for review.
   - 4/8 - LITW Board Mtg - Approve draft by-laws
   - 4/16 - Per current by-laws any "amendments or changes shall be posted on the bulletin board for the membership to read and study at least 30 days before final action is to be taken on the proposed amendments or changes". A copy of the LITW Board approved draft by-laws will be posted on bulletin board.
   - 5/18 - Start LITW Board review of the membership's comments.
   - 6/10 - Approval of final by-laws at 6/10/26 LITW meeting.
   - 7/8 - Implement new by-laws.

4. Set a timeline for LITW membership application, processing and renewal to align with the IRS, PA Dept of Rev, and PA Liquor Enforcement laws, regulations, and codes. LITW membership processing and recording must be independent and separate from all other types of memberships. The Post, Post SAL, Post AUX, and Post Riders were briefed months ago.

   Timeline:
   - 3/3 - Draft docs out to LITW Board
   - 4/8 - Board discussion of docs at LITW meeting
   - 5/13 - LITW Board approval
   - 7/1 - Start membership processing discussions with the Post, SAL, and AUX